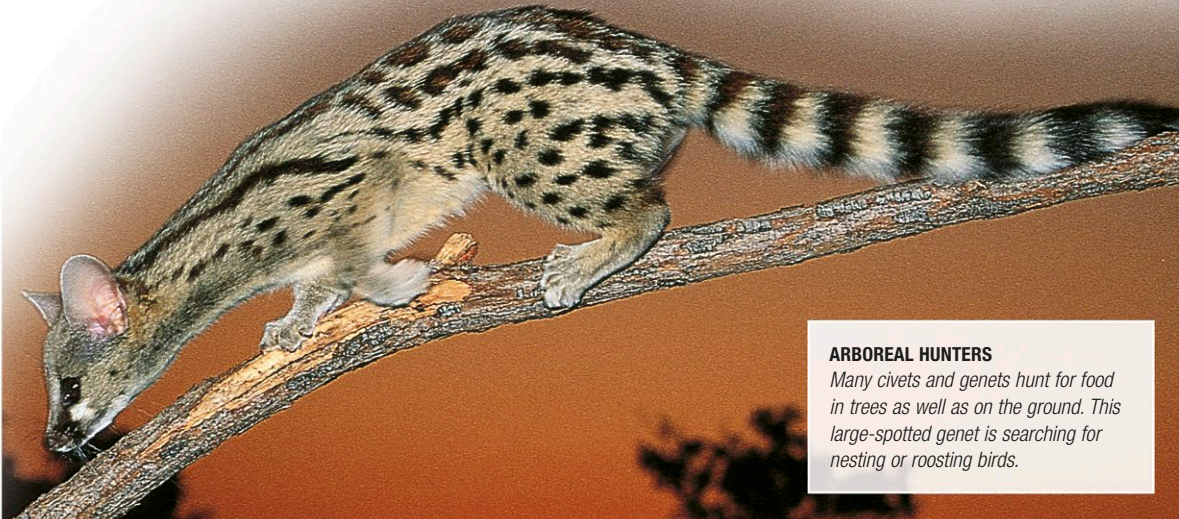


Civets and relatives

PHYLUM	Chordata
CLASS	Mammalia
ORDER	Carnivora
FAMILY	Viverridae
SPECIES	34

Animals in this family—which includes the civets, genets, and binturong—usually have a slender body and long tail. They are related to cats and hyenas but are more primitive, with a longer snout and additional teeth. Viverrids are distributed throughout Africa, southern Asia, and southeastern Europe, and are found in rain forest, woodland, and savanna. Most are terrestrial, but there are arboreal species (for example, the binturong) and semiaquatic ones (for example, otter genets).

Anatomy
Viverrids typically have a long body and tail, short legs, an elongated neck and head, and a tapered snout. Most civets and genets have spots in longitudinal rows along the body; the binturong has plain black fur. All species have scent glands in the anal region, and in civets these glands produce a substance used to make perfume.



ARBOREAL HUNTERS
Many civets and genets hunt for food in trees as well as on the ground. This large-spotted genet is searching for nesting or roosting birds.

Paradoxurus hermaphroditus

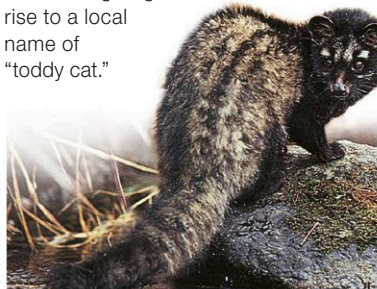
Common palm civet



Length	17–28 in (43–71 cm)
Tail	16–26 in (40–66 cm)
Weight	3¼–10 lb (1.5–4.5 kg)
Location	S., E., and S.E. Asia
Social unit	Individual
Status	Least concern



This adaptable, bushy-tailed civet is brownish gray with black stripes on its back, dark flank spots, and a polecat-like “face mask.” It stays mainly in trees but may rest by day in a house or on an outbuilding roof. The diet includes much fruit, especially figs, as well as buds, grasses, small animals such as insects and mice, and sometimes poultry. Fermented palm-tree juice is a favorite, giving rise to a local name of “toddy cat.”



Viverra zangara

Malay civet



Length	21½–30½ in (54–77.5 cm)
Tail	10–16 in (26–40 cm)
Weight	6½–15 lb (3–7 kg)
Location	S.E. Asia
Social unit	Individual
Status	Least concern



In addition to the typical civet coat of many dark spots forming lines along the body, this species has a distinctive black-and-white neck collar, white underside, black legs and feet, and about 15 bands along the

tail. It climbs only occasionally and feeds mainly on forest-floor creatures including millipedes, giant centipedes, scorpions, and small mammals such as mice. Widespread and common throughout Southeast Asia, the Malay civet is nocturnal and solitary, and lives for up to 11 years.



Genetta genetta

Common genet



Length	18¼–20½ in (46.5–52 cm)
Tail	16–20 in (40–51 cm)
Weight	3¼–5½ lb (1.5–2.5 kg)
Location	W., E., and S. Africa, Arabian Peninsula
Social unit	Individual
Status	Least concern



This very catlike species has semiretractile claws and is an excellent climber. It takes a variety of small mammals, birds, eggs, grubs, and fruit.

In some areas it raids farms for poultry and is considered a pest. The den is a sheltered area under roots or in thick bushes. After the gestation period of 70–77 days, typically 2 young are born with eyes closed. Litter size ranges between 1 and 4.



Arctictis binturong

Binturong



Length	24–38 in (61–96 cm)
Tail	20–33 in (50–84 cm)
Weight	20–44 lb (9–20 kg)
Location	S. and S.E. Asia
Social unit	Individual
Status	Vulnerable



The binturong has shaggy black fur and tufted ears. Its tail is long-haired and prehensile at the tip. It moves slowly and cautiously among branches in search of fruit, shoots, and small animals such as insects, birds, and rodents. By day, it curls up on a secluded branch to rest, but may continue to feed. Individuals mark their territories with scent. The 1–6, usually 2, young, born after a gestation of 92 days, reach adult size in one year.



Prionodon pardicolor

Oriental linsang



Length	12–18 in (31–45 cm)
Tail	12–16 in (30–40 cm)
Weight	1¼–3 lb (0.6–1.2 kg)
Location	S., E., and S.E. Asia
Social unit	Individual
Status	Least concern



This small, slender, sinuous linsang has recently been reclassified as belonging to the Prionodontidae, a sister family of the Viverridae. Both sexes are generally solitary and nocturnal, with large ears and big eyes adapted for night vision. The male is almost twice the size of the female. Its diet consists of small animals, such as frogs, snakes, rats, and mice, as well as carrion. The average litter size is 2–3.